

Glossary

abdomen part of an animal's body that contains digestive and reproductive organs

algae simple, plantlike living things that make their own food using energy from sunlight

alloparenting care given to a young animal by an adult that is not one of its parents

anadromous used to describe fish, such as salmon, that migrate from salt water to freshwater to spawn

asexual reproduction reproduction involving a single parent

atmosphere layer of gases that surrounds a planet

black dwarf dark, dead remains of a white dwarf star that has cooled

black hole region of space where gravity is so strong that not even light can escape from it. A black hole forms when a large star collapses into itself

breeding producing offspring (baby organisms) by mating

chrysalis pupa stage of a butterfly or moth

clone plant or animal that is a replica of its parent. Clones are produced by asexual reproduction

cocoon case made of silk that protects an insect while it is pupating

colony a number of living things of the same kind that live closely together

commensalism relationship where one species benefits, but the other neither benefits nor suffers harm

conservation working to protect the natural world

courtship animal behavior that forms a bond between a male and a female before mating

crust Earth's hard, outermost layer

deciduous plants that lose all their leaves at the same time, leaving the plant bare. They grow new leaves the following year

decomposing rotting or decaying. The bodies of animals and plants decompose after they die

drupe fleshy fruit usually containing a hard stonelike seed. Coconuts, plums, cherries, and peaches are drupes

egg fertilized female sex cell that develops into a new animal. Some eggs develop inside the mother's body, while others are laid. The eggs of birds and reptiles are enclosed by shells

egg cell female sex cell

embryo early stage of development of an animal or plant

endangered at risk of becoming extinct (dying out altogether)

erosion when rocks are worn down and carried away by wind, running water, or the moving ice of glaciers

evaporation when a liquid changes to a gas

evergreen plant that sheds and regrows its leaves all the time, so that the plant is never without leaves

exoskeleton hard, outer skeleton surrounding the body of some animals

fertilization fusing (joining) of male and female sex cells to produce a new living thing

fetus unborn mammal in the later stages of development

fruit ripened female part of a flower that contains seeds. Some fruits have a juicy wall to encourage animals to eat them and spread their seeds

fungi type of living thing that absorbs food from living or dead matter around it

galaxy very large group of stars and clouds of gas and dust

germinate when a seed starts to grow

hermaphrodite living thing that has both male and female reproductive parts. Earthworms are hermaphrodites

hibernation sleep-like state that helps animals survive through winter

host living thing that provides food for a parasite

igneous rock rock that forms when magma cools underground or when lava solidifies on the surface

incubate to keep eggs warm until they are ready to hatch

larva young animal that is quite unlike its parents and which changes into an adult by complete metamorphosis (plural: larvae)

lava hot, molten rock that erupts onto Earth's surface from volcanoes

litter a group of young born to an animal at a single time